

FZIS Mawlid un Nabi Q&A + Kahoot Preparation

The first 40 questions below are based on the booklet *SiratLink Volume1 Issue4.pdf*.

Additional questions are also provided after these 40 questions, which may be helpful for preparing for the Kahoot quiz and Q&A session.

Question 1

What does the Arabic term *Ṣirāṭ al-Mustaṭīm* mean, and how did it inspire the title of the quarterly magazine?

- **Answer:** It translates to "**the right path**". The title *Ṣirāṭ Link* represents the magazine as a means of guidance to build a greater connection to Allah, establish ties with the broader community, and improve oneself.

Question 2

Whose birth anniversaries are celebrated during the Islamic lunar month of Rabīʿ ul-Awwal?

- **Answer:** The birth of Prophet Muḥammad (ṣ) and the sixth Imām, Imām Jaʿfar aṣ-Ṣādiq (ʿa).

Question 3

How should we celebrate the Prophet's (ṣ) birthday on the 12th or the 17th of Rabīʿ ul-Awwal?

- **Answer:** He suggested that instead of arguing over a single day, they should have a **whole week of celebrations** to honor the best creation of Allah.

Question 4

How did Imām Jaʿfar aṣ-Ṣādiq (ʿa) historically demonstrate religious accommodation when answering the questions of Christians and Jews?

- **Answer:** He answered their theological questions by using and referencing **their own holy books**.

Question 5

What is the the root cause of the disasters facing the Muslim ummah today?

- **Answer:** The root cause is moving away from the ethic rooted in **Lā ilāha illallāh** (the oneness of Allah) and failing to practice the values of freedom, human rights, equality, and unity that stem from it.

Question 6

What is the only standard of distinction or measure in Islam, and who is the sole judge of it?

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- **Answer: Taqwā** (God-consciousness), and only Allah has the authority to judge or measure it.

Question 7

In what year did Prophet Muḥammad (ṣ) migrate to the northern city of Medina, and what was the main reason the local leaders invited him?

- **Answer:** He migrated in the year **622 A.D.** because of the Quraysh's assassination attempts on his life. The leaders of Medina invited him to help resolve their intense tribal disputes.

Question 8

How many years after the Prophet's arrival in Medina did the leaders of Mecca gather an army to attack, and what was their primary objective?

- **Answer: Two years** after his arrival. Their objective was to ransack Medina, kill the Prophet, and put an end to the spreading message of Allah.

Question 9

Compare the sizes and equipment levels of the Meccan army and the Muslim army at the Battle of Badr.

- **Answer:** The Meccan army was a fully equipped force of around **1,300 soldiers**, whereas the Muslim army consisted of poorly equipped soldiers numbering around **313 men**.

Question 10

Who led the Meccan army at the Battle of Badr, and what was his fate?

- **Answer: Abū Jahl**, who was the Prophet's uncle and a sworn enemy of Islam. He died as a result of that battle.

Question 11

Who was the leader of the Meccans during the Battle of Uḥud, and what went wrong for the Muslims during this battle?

- **Answer: Abū Sufyān.** A number of Muslims did not follow the Prophet's battle plans and made critical mistakes, leading to a stalemate, the deaths of many Muslims, and the injury of the Prophet himself.

Question 12

In what year did the Battle of Khandaq take place, and how large was the Meccan army?

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- **Answer: 627 A.D (5AH).** The Meccan army consisted of **ten thousand men**.

Question 13

Who suggested the strategy of digging trenches around Medina to prevent Meccan entry, and what was his background?

- **Answer: Salmān al-Farsī**, the Persian companion of the Prophet.

Question 14

How did the Prophet dismantle the conspiracy of Meccan-allied confederates attempting to attack the Muslims from within Medina during the siege of Khandaq?

- **Answer:** He uncovered the plot and managed to disband the conspiracy through **diplomacy**.

Question 15

What two factors combined to shatter the morale of the Meccan army and force their retreat from the siege of Medina?

- **Answer:** The dismantling of their internal conspiracy and **bad weather**.

Question 16

According to the Prophet's narration, what is the difference between his "companions" and his "brothers"?

- **Answer:** His companions are those who lived with him. His brothers are those who **have faith in him although they never saw him**.

Question 17

In the story shared about Imām al-Mahdī (‘aj) and a watch seller, how did the watch seller demonstrate ethical trading?

- **Answer:** He refused to buy a watch for \$5 from a needy old lady, informing her that it was worth \$7. He bought it for \$7 to ensure she got its worth while keeping a reasonable, halal profit of \$3 for resale at \$10.

Question 18

What did Imām al-Mahdī (‘aj) tell the seeker who was trying to find him about how to earn his visitation?

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- **Answer:** He told him: *"Look, you don't have to run after us, we'll come to you if you behave with justice and the true moral and ethical traits of a human being like this person"*.

Question 19

Who is Abu Ali al-Hasan ibn al-Hasan ibn al-Haytham (Alhazen), and what is his major contribution to the study of motion?

- **Answer:** He was a 10th-century scientist from Iraq credited with discovering the **principle of inertia**, along with pioneering research in optics.

Question 20

What is the 8th-century scientist Abu Musa Jabir ibn Hayyan synonymous with, and whose disciple was he?

- **Answer:** He is synonymous with utmost authority in **alchemy/chemistry**. He was a disciple of **Imām Ja'far aṣ-Ṣādiq ('a)**.

Question 21

Who is regarded as "the father of algebra" in the 8th century, and what did his works comprise?

- **Answer: Muhammad ibn Musa al-Khawarazmi.** His works comprised the development of algebra, geometric solutions, degree measurements, and trigonometric tables.

Question 22

Why is Abu Rayhan Al-Biruni regarded as the "father of geodesy"?

- **Answer:** Because he made detailed scientific studies on the **physical measurements of the surface of the Earth**.

Question 23

What is the title of the geography book written by Al-Biruni?

- **Answer:** *The Book of the Demarcation of the Limits of Areas*.

Question 24

Describe the tribal customs and moral degradation of Arabian society during the era of "jāhiliyyah" (ignorance) before Islam.

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- **Answer:** It was characterized by constant tribal warfare, brutal customs like **burying newborn girls alive** because daughters were seen as burdens, greed among rich clans who exploited the poor, and very few people believing in the one true God.

Question 25

According to the Prophet's own words, what was the primary purpose of his mission?

- **Answer: "I was sent to perfect akhlāq (moral character)".**

Question 26

How did the Prophet show mercy to his enemies after being injured in the Battle of Uḥud?

- **Answer:** He prayed to Allah to overlook the actions of his enemies because they were in a state of ignorance.

Question 27

What was "Ḥilf al-Fuḍūl" (the Covenant of High Morals), and what did its members promise?

- **Answer:** A treaty created by the Prophet and other youths in Mecca to **help any stranger or foreigner who entered the city** without tribal or family support to prevent them from being treated cruelly.

Question 28

What condition did Abū Sufyān and other wealthy tribal leaders demand in exchange for accepting Islam, and how did the Prophet respond?

- **Answer:** They demanded that they would **not have to be associated with the poor, slaves, or other races**. The Prophet refused, demonstrating the importance of destroying tribal arrogance.

Question 29

How long did the Meccan boycott of Muslims last, and who spent all their wealth to provide for the community?

- **Answer:** The boycott lasted for **three years**. The Prophet's uncle, Abū Ṭālib, and his wife, Lady Khadījah, used all of their wealth to support the Muslims.

Question 30

How did the Prophet choose where to stay upon arriving in Medina when multiple wealthy families offered him hospitality?

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- **Answer:** He allowed his camel to roam freely and stop on its own. The camel stopped before the house of **Abū Ayyūb al-Anṣari, the poorest man in Medina**, showing that the Prophet would not give preferential treatment to the wealthy or influential.

Question 31

What is the literal meaning of the Arabic root "wa-qa-ya" from which the term "taqwā" is derived?

- **Answer:** It means "**protection**" or "**support**".

Question 32

Why is translating "taqwā" simply as "fear" considered incorrect, and how is fear properly related to taqwā?

- **Answer:** Taqwā is self-restraint and God-consciousness. Having fear is a prerequisite to protecting oneself from harm and is **a result of taqwā, but not taqwā itself**.

Question 33

Why is fear without hope toward Allah described as toxic and dangerous for faith?

- **Answer:** It creates hopelessness in the infinite mercy of Allah, which is a serious sin. The Ahl al-Bayt (‘a) taught that a believer must seek proximity using two wings: **fear and hope**.

Question 34

What does Imām ‘Alī as-Sajjād (‘a) state regarding fear and hope in the Du‘ā of Abū Ḥamzah Thumālī?

- **Answer:** *"O, My Lord! When I look at the sins I have committed, I become fearful, and when I look at Your generosity, I harbor hope".*

Question 35

According to the narration of Imām Muḥammad al-Jawād (‘a), how can a believer use their heart to distinguish between permissible acts and sins?

- **Answer:** The heart will tell the truth; it will be **at ease with ḥalāl** (permissible actions) and will be **disturbed with sins**.

Question 36

What is the daily practice of "mushāratah"?

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- **Answer:** Making a firm intention on a daily basis to stay away from all sin and perform all lawful duties, directly advising one's inner self (*nafs*) to stay on the straight path.

Question 37

What is the practice of "murāqabah"?

- **Answer:** Remaining vigilant throughout the day to avoid sin and ensure responsibilities are performed, recognizing that we are always in the presence of Allah.

Question 38

What is "muḥāsabah", and what advice did Imām 'Alī ('a) give to Abū Dharr regarding it?

- **Answer:** Muḥāsabah is the end-of-day self-examination where one reviews their actions. Imām 'Alī ('a) advised: *"O Abū Dharr! Hold yourself accountable before they hold you accountable, and for your accounting to be easy tomorrow"*.

Question 39

Who compiled the *Nahj al-Balāghah*, when was he born, and who trained him?

- **Answer:** Sayyid Sharif al-Radi, who was born in Baghdad in the year 359 A.H. He was trained alongside his brother Sayyid Murtada by the great Shī'ah theologian **Shaykh al-Mufid**.

Question 40

In what year was the compilation of *Nahj al-Balāghah* completed, and what is its composition in terms of sermons, letters, and sayings of Imām 'Alī ('a)?

- **Answer:** Completed in the year **400 A.H.**, it is comprised of **239 sermons, 79 letters, and 489 sayings**.

Below are some additional questions provided to prepare for Q&A and Kahoot!

Question 1:

What is the literal translation of the Arabic word "Ayah" used in the Quran,

Answer: "Ayah" translates directly to "sign" or "miracle". This term is used to teach that every single sentence of the Holy Quran is considered an individual miracle in its own right.

Question 2:

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Why are the miracles of previous prophets considered "temporary" whereas the Quran is considered a "lasting" miracle?

Answer: The miracles of previous prophets were physical and temporary because their respective prophetic missions were temporary. In contrast, the Quran is an everlasting, lasting miracle because the mission of Prophet Muhammad is designed to remain forever.

Question 3:

How does the Quran's manner of addressing other prophets differ from how it addresses Prophet Muhammad, and what does this show?

Answer: The Quran addresses previous prophets directly by their names (e.g., "Ya Musa" or "Ya Ibrahim"), but never addresses Prophet Muhammad directly by his first name. Instead, God addresses him by his titles, such as "Ya ayyuha al-Rasul" (O Messenger) or "Ya ayyuha al-Nabi" (O Prophet), showing that he holds the highest spiritual rank among all prophets.

Question 4:

How many distinct divine signs (miracles) were granted to Prophet Moses (Musa) during his mission?

Answer: Prophet Moses was granted exactly nine (9) signs to establish his authority as a law-making prophet.

Question 5:

According to the unanimous consensus of scholars and philosophers, what was the very first creation and manifestation of God?

Answer: The first creation and manifestation of God, existing prior to the physical universe, is the Light of Muhammad (Noor Muhammad).

Question 6:

Give a simple example to understand why Muslims are required to believe in and recognize all prophets of God despite their different ranks?

Answer: We can think of different teachers in a school who teach different grades of mathematics. Just because a student is currently in a higher grade does not mean they deny or reject the mathematics teachers of other grades; all are recognized as legitimate teachers of the school.

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Question 7:

If 124,000 prophets were to hypothetically live together in a city like Brisbane, how would their relationships differ from ordinary human professionals?

Answer: Unlike ordinary professionals or academics who often disagree or criticize one another, there would be absolutely no disagreement or dispute among the 124,000 prophets because they are all connected directly to the absolute, singular Truth.

Question 8:

If the prophets themselves have no disagreements, where do the religious disputes and differences actually come from?

Answer: Disputes and differences arise entirely among the followers of the prophets after their departure. This occurs because the followers no longer have direct access to the actual Truth, causing them to divide based on their own differing assumptions and beliefs.

Question 9:

Why does the Quran refer to itself as a "Book of Remembrance" (Dhikr)?

Answer: It is called a book of remembrance because its purpose is to remind human beings of the spiritual covenant and knowledge they had already accepted and possessed in the spirit world prior to their physical birth, rather than teaching them unfamiliar concepts from scratch.

Question 10:

Why will human beings be unable to blame their parents or claim they were never taught about God on the Day of Judgment?

Answer: Because in the spirit world, prior to physical birth, God took a direct covenant from all the children of Adam, showing Himself to them and receiving their testimony that He is their Lord. This left an indelible proof of God's existence directly embedded within human instinct.

Question 11:

Which non-Muslim author described Prophet Muhammad as the number 1 most influential person in human history?

Answer: Michael Hart (spelled phonetically as "michel" in the transcript), the author of the book The 100: A Ranking of the Most Influential Persons in History.

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Question 12:

What is the significance of the Arabic word "tilka" (meaning "those") when the Quran refers to the messengers in verse 2:253 ("Tilka al-rusulu...")?

Answer: In Arabic, "tilka" is a demonstrative pronoun used for things that are physically far away. The Quran uses it to refer to the messengers as an expression of spiritual respect; even though they are physically human and close, their spiritual status is so elevated that they are spiritually far above ordinary people.

Question 13:

What is the consensus among Muslims regarding the lineage of Prophet Muhammad up to Prophet Ibrahim?

Answer: There is complete unanimity that Prophet Muhammad is a direct descendant of the lineage of Prophet Ibrahim through his son Prophet Ismail.

Question 14:

Up to which specific ancestor is there no genealogical dispute or difference in names, and who is this ancestor in relation to the Prophet?

Answer: There is no dispute up to Adnan, who is the 21st grandfather of Prophet Muhammad.

Question 15:

What is the majority view among Shia scholars regarding whether all of the Prophet's ancestors were actual prophets?

Answer: It is not unanimously accepted that they were all prophets. While a minority of scholars hold that view, the majority agree that his ancestors were monotheists, but not necessarily prophets who received divine revelation or missions.

Question 16:

What divine inspiration did the Prophet's grandfather, Abdul Mutalib, receive in a dream?

Answer: He was inspired with the exact location of the Well of Zamzam, which had been covered up and lost for many years, allowing him to dig it up and recover the lost Black Stone.

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Question 17:

To what extent does the Quran say the Jews and Christians recognized the description of the coming of Prophet Muhammad in their scriptures?

Answer: The Quran states that they recognized the Prophet as clearly and deeply as one would recognize their own children.

Question 18:

How is the geographical location "Paran" mentioned in biblical prophecies connected to the advent of Islam?

Answer: Paran refers to the mountainous wilderness surrounding Mecca, which is specifically where the Prophet Muhammad received his first divine revelation on Mount Hira.

Question 19:

What is the origin and literal meaning of the name of the Prophet's great-grandfather, Hashim?

Answer: His actual name was Amr, but he was nicknamed Hashim because during a severe drought, he generously cut bread into pieces (hashm) to make curry to feed the people.

Question 20:

Why is the year of the Prophet's birth called the "Year of the Elephant," and how did God establish this year as a primary historical marker for the Arabs?

Answer: It is named after Abraha's army of elephants that attempted to destroy the Kaaba. Since the Gregorian calendar was not in use and the exact birth dates of prophets like Jesus were lost, God miraculously preserved this year as a permanent turning point so Arabs could date all subsequent events relative to it.

Question 21:

What was Abdul Muttalib's response to Abraha when negotiating before the attack on Mecca?

Answer: He only demanded the return of his stolen camels, famously stating: "I am only the owner of my camels, and this house has a Lord who will protect it".

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Question 22:

How was Abraha's army destroyed as they entered Mecca?

Answer: God sent flocks of birds (Ababil) carrying small clay stones in their beaks and claws. When dropped, these stones pierced through the flesh and bones of the soldiers, instantly killing them.

Question 23:

Why were the names "Muhammad" and "Ahmad" virtually non-existent in the Arabian Peninsula prior to the Prophet's birth?

Answer: These names, which mean "the praised one," were not traditional Arab names. Only a few families (ranging from 3 to 16) who had heard Jewish prophecies of a coming prophet named their children Muhammad in hopes that their son would be the chosen one.

Question 24:

What spiritual change occurred regarding Satan (Shaitan) on the night of the Prophet's birth?

Answer: Satan was completely cast away and barred from all seven heavens, drastically limiting his power to mislead humanity and preserve idol worship.

Question 25:

What physical events occurred in the Persian Empire on the night the Prophet was born?

Answer: The veranda of the palace of the Persian King (Chosroes/Kisra) shook and cracked, and the Lake of Sawa miraculously dried up.

Question 26:

What is "Hilf al-Fudul" (Covenant of the Virtuous), and what was the core objective of those who signed it?

Answer: It was a covenant of fraternity and mutual protection signed in Mecca. Its core objective was to act as a support system to defend and assist anyone, especially strangers and foreigners, who was treated unfairly or cheated within the city.

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Question 27:

What specific commercial dispute involving a foreign merchant triggered the establishment of the Hilf al-Fudul covenant?

Answer: A foreign trader came to Mecca to sell his goods, but the local buyer refused to pay him. Being a helpless stranger, the trader climbed a hill and loudly cried out for help, prompting virtuous citizens to gather, form the covenant, and force the buyer to return the money.

Question 28:

How did Imam Hussein leverage the legacy of the Hilf al-Fudul covenant decades later in Medina?

Answer: When Walid, the governor of Medina, refused to return Imam Hussein's wealth, the Imam sent a message threatening to call upon the Arabs under the principles of Hilf al-Fudul. Because the covenant was so respected, the threat forced the governor to immediately return his wealth.

Question 29:

What highly respected title did the Prophet earn from the people of Mecca by the age of 25, and how did he earn it?

Answer: He earned the title "Al-Amin" (The Trustworthy). He earned this because the citizens of Mecca trusted him completely to safeguard their goods, trade caravans, and wealth.

Question 30:

What is "Mudarabah" in Islamic business, and how did it structure the initial partnership between the Prophet and Lady Khadijah?

Answer: It is a partnership where one party provides the investment capital and the other provides the physical work, with the resulting profits divided half-and-half. This structured their partnership when Khadijah invested her wealth in a Syrian business caravan managed by the Prophet.

Question 31:

Who were the first three individuals who comprised the earliest Islamic community worshipping God together in Mecca?

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Answer: The early community consisted of Prophet Muhammad, his wife Khadijah, and Imam Ali.

Question 32:

How did the Prophet resolve the intense dispute over which tribe would place the Black Stone (Hajar al-Aswad) during the Kaaba's renovation?

Answer: He placed the Black Stone on a piece of fabric, instructed a representative from each competing tribe to hold a corner of the cloth to lift it together, and then personally placed the stone into its final position, preventing tribal bloodshed.

Question 33:

What is the pre-Islamic era in the Arabian Peninsula technically referred to as?

Answer: It is referred to as the age of ignorance (Jahiliyyah).

Question 34:

What are the four primary historical and literary sources used to study the culture of the pre-Islamic age of ignorance?

Answer:

1. The Holy Quran
2. The Hadiths of the Prophet
3. Pre-Islamic poetry (such as the poems hung around the Kaaba)
4. Ancient historical books, specifically Kitab al-Asnam (Book of Idols) written by the second-century historian Hisham ibn al-Kalbi.

Question 35:

What is the historical explanation regarding Amr ibn Luhayy and how idolatry originally spread to the monotheistic descendants of Prophet Ismail in Arabia?

Answer: Amr ibn Luhayy traveled to Syria to seek a cure for an illness, encountered local idol worship there, became attracted to the practice, and brought an idol back to introduce to the Arabian Peninsula.

Question 36:

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Which major pagan idol did the Quraysh carry with them during their first battle against the Muslims, and what did Abu Sufyan shout regarding it?

Answer: The idol was Al-Uzza, and Abu Sufyan shouted, "We have Al-Uzza and you have no Uzza".

Question 37:

How did Prophet Muhammad respond to the superstition that a solar eclipse occurred out of grief for the death of his young son Ibrahim?

Answer: He rejected the superstition, clarifying that the sun and moon do not eclipse out of sympathy or grief for anyone's death.

Question 38:

What is the difference between a Prophet (Nabi) and a Messenger (Rasul) regarding receiving and declaring divine revelation?

Answer: A Prophet (Nabi) receives inspiration and revelation for his own personal practice, whereas a Messenger (Rasul) has a public mission to declare the message, guide people, and share a book.

Question 39:

At what point in his life did the Prophet receive prophethood (nubuwwah)?

Answer: He was chosen as a Prophet (Nabi) from the time of his weaning as a child, during which he was continuously supported and guided by the Holy Spirit (Ruha).

Question 40:

What Quranic example of another prophet is used to prove that God is fully capable of choosing a prophet during infancy?

Answer: Prophet Jesus (Isa), who declared his prophethood and scripture while still an infant in the cradle.

Question 41:

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What does the phrase "the only religion with Allah is Islam" signify about all the historical prophets?

Answer: It signifies that all divine prophets—including Nuh, Ibrahim, Moses, and Jesus—actually preached and established the same single religion of submission to God, which is Islam.

Question 42:

At what age did Prophet Muhammad officially become a Messenger (Rasul)?

Answer: He was appointed as a Messenger of Allah at the age of 40.

Question 43:

What are the first two historical instances on Earth where the coming of Prophet Muhammad as a messenger was prophesied?

Answer: The first instance was when Prophet Ibrahim and his son Ismail built the Kaaba and prayed for a messenger to be sent from among their descendants. The second was when Prophet Jesus (Isa) gave glad tidings of a coming messenger named Ahmad.

Question 44:

How is the physical structure and size of the Cave of Hira described?

Answer: It is not a natural cave, but rather overlapping pieces of rock that fell on each other over Earth's history. Inside, it is tall enough for an ordinary person to stand, and is about 1.5 to 2 meters in length, providing enough room for one person to sit, prostrate, and worship.

Question 45:

What is the systematic rule for dealing with any hadith or narration that directly contradicts the Holy Quran?

Answer: Any narration that contradicts the Quran is considered invalid and rejected because the Prophet would never say or do anything that goes against the holy book.

Question 46:

How does Imam Ali describe his own experience of the first revelation in Nahj al-Balagha?

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Answer: Imam Ali stated that he was present, saw the light of the divine revelation, and heard the painful groaning of Satan when the revelation descended. The Prophet confirmed that Ali could see and hear what he did, though Ali was not a messenger.

Question 47:

According to the narrations of the Ahl al-Bayt, how did the Prophet actually react when he descended Mount Hira after his appointment?

Answer: He was overjoyed and excited. As he walked down the mountain, every rock, stone, and plant he passed miraculously offered salutations, greeting him as the Messenger of God

Question 48:

How many individuals in the entire tribe of Quraish in Mecca were recorded as being literate at the advent of Islam?

Answer: Historical records indicate that there were only 17 people in the entire tribe who knew how to read and write.

Question 49:

How does the reaction of Prophet Moses's followers to a call to fight compare with the loyalty shown by the companions of Prophet Muhammad?

Answer: When Prophet Moses told his followers to enter their hometown and fight the tyrants, the Israelites refused, telling him to go with his Lord and fight while they sat behind. In contrast, the companions of Prophet Muhammad remained exceptionally loyal, standing firm and supporting the message of Islam through more than 40 wars, even when told that the entire world was united against them.

Question 50:

According to historical accounts, who is considered the very first disciple to betray Prophet Jesus?

Answer: One of the close disciples of Prophet Jesus, who was part of his inner circle, reported him to the ruling government.

Question 51:

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Who are the three individuals identified by the Prophet as the most truthful people (the Siddiqun) in human history?

Answer: The three individuals are Imam Ali, the companion of Yasin (Habib al-Najjar) from the time of Jesus, and the believer from the family of Pharaoh who rescued Moses.

Question 52:

Why did Prophet Muhammad bring a young Imam Ali to live in his own household?

Answer: The Prophet's uncle, Abu Talib, was facing severe financial difficulties and had a very large family to support. To relieve his uncle's financial burden, the Prophet took Ali to raise in his house, while Abbas took Ja'far.

Question 53:

Why did Abu Talib hide his Islamic belief and pretend to remain a non-Muslim?

Answer: He held a highly respected, noble status among the Quraish. By keeping his faith secret, he was able to maintain his influential position and use it to protect the Prophet far more effectively than he could have if he had openly joined the Muslim camp.

Question 54:

Which two major world religions are classified as proselytizing religions, meaning their adherents are expected to actively introduce and invite others to convert?

Answer: Islam and Christianity are both categorized as proselytizing religions.

Question 55:

How long did the initial, secret stage of inviting individuals to Islam last before the Prophet publicly announced his mission?

Answer: This initial stage lasted for about three years.

Question 56:

What did early Muslims do to perform congregational prayers safely during the initial years of Islam in Mecca?

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Answer: They held prayers secretly inside secure private homes, such as the Prophet's house, or gathered in secluded spots between the mountains on the outskirts of Mecca to avoid being seen.

Question 57:

What analogy did the Prophet use to describe his role when he first publicly announced his mission to the people of Mecca?

Answer: He compared his position to a warner in an army who runs back to warn the soldiers of an incoming, inevitable danger so that they can be prepared.

Question 58:

What was the biological relationship of Abu Lahab to Prophet Muhammad, and how did he react to the first public announcement of Islam?

Answer: Abu Lahab was the Prophet's uncle; he immediately ridiculed the Prophet, asking if that was the only reason they had been gathered, and did not let people think independently about the message.

Question 59:

What miracle occurred during the dinner when the Prophet invited approximately 40 of his close relatives to his house to introduce Islam?

Answer: The only food prepared was a single leg of mutton cooked with milk, which the guests initially mocked as insufficient for even one man. However, after the Prophet instructed them to say "Bismillah," all 40 men ate until they were fully satisfied, and a piece of meat still remained on the table.

Question 60:

What is the historical name of the event where the Prophet gathered his relatives at his house to warn them and deliver his message?

Answer: This event is called "the Day of Warning" or "the Day of the House" (Yawm al-Inzar / Yawm al-Dar).

Question 61:

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What did the Prophet promise to whichever of his relatives accepted his invitation first during the Day of the House?

Answer: He promised that the first person to accept his invitation would be his brother, his heir, and his successor.

Question 62:

According to scholars like Allamah Majlisi, approximately how many miracles did the Prophet perform throughout his life in addition to the Quran?

Answer: The Prophet performed more than 4,400 miracles.

Question 63:

Why do Islamic scholars emphasize the Holy Quran as the primary living miracle of the Prophet rather than his physical miracles?

Answer: Physical miracles, such as healing the blind or reviving the dead, are temporary and cannot be physically demonstrated to skeptics today. The Quran remains a permanent, living miracle because it is the actual word of God and contains an ongoing challenge to produce even a single chapter like it.

Question 64:

What did the Prophet recite to Utbah when the chief offered the Prophet wealth, fame, leadership, or medical help in exchange for abandoning his mission?

Answer: The Prophet recited verses from Surah Fussilat (beginning with "Ha Mim..."), which left Utbah so shocked and amazed that he returned to the Quraysh and strongly advised them to leave the Prophet alone.

Question 65:

What did some of the eloquent chiefs of Quraysh secretly do under the cover of darkness in Mecca?

Answer: They went separately to stand behind the walls of the Prophet's house at night to secretly listen to and enjoy his recitation of the Quran.

Question 66:

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Preparation

Why did a Meccan man freeze in terror, start shaking, and run away mid-recitation when asking the Prophet to read some of his "poems"?

Answer: The Prophet clarified that his words were not poetry but the words of God, and began reciting verses warning of a destructive thunderbolt (sa'iqah) like the one that struck 'Ad and Thamud, which terrified the man so much that he fled.

Question 67:

What metaphor is used to describe the relationship between patience (sabr) and faith (iman)?

Answer: Patience is compared to the head of a physical body. Just as a body cannot survive without its head, faith cannot exist or survive without patience.

Question 68:

Which Surah is said to have aged the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ because of its strong command to remain steadfast?

Answer: Surah Hud. It contains a strong command to remain firm and patient on the right path, even during difficulties.

Question 69:

What did the Prophet say when the Quraysh offered him fame, position, and wealth to abandon his public mission?

Answer: The Prophet responded that even if they were to put the sun in his right hand and the moon in his left hand, he would never give up his mission and would carry it out until completion.

Question 70:

How did the Prophet's uncle Hamzah react when he learned that Abu Jahl had publicly ridiculed and hurt the Prophet?

Answer: Hamzah immediately confronted Abu Jahl in front of his friends, struck him on the head with his bow so hard that it caused him to bleed, and publicly declared his support for Prophet Muhammad, which marked his alignment with Islam.

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Question 71:

What happened to the companion who courageously volunteered to openly recite the Quran (Surah al-Rahman) in Masjid al-Haram?

Answer: He was brutally attacked, slapped, and beaten left and right by the polytheists until his face was covered in blood and he fainted. Despite this, upon waking, he declared that the enemies had never looked smaller to him and offered to do it again the next day.

Question 72:

How was the companion Bilal tortured by his master Umayyah, and how was he eventually rescued?

Answer: Umayyah dragged Bilal out during the hottest part of the summer, laid him on burning pebbles, placed a large, heavy rock on his chest, and demanded he denounce the Prophet. He was rescued when the Prophet instructed his uncle Abbas to purchase Bilal from his master using money, thereby freeing him.

Question 73:

Why did Bilal refuse to pay allegiance to the first caliph, Abu Bakr, after the demise of the Prophet, and what was the consequence?

Answer: Bilal refused because he believed that a successor not appointed by Allah and His Messenger could not hold the position of successorship, maintaining that his allegiance belonged only to the divinely appointed successor. As a result, he was exiled to the borders of the Muslim territory.

Question 74:

Who were the first male and female martyrs in the history of Islam, and how did they die?

Answer: Yasir was the first male martyr and his wife Sumayyah (the mother of Ammar) was the first female martyr. Both died under severe, relentless torture inflicted by the polytheists of Mecca for refusing to renounce their faith.

Question 75:

How did the Prophet comfort Ammar bin Yasir after Ammar was forced to verbally denounce Islam to escape life-threatening torture?

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Answer: The Prophet reassured him not to worry because his heart remained completely firm in faith. He told Ammar that if the torturers ever captured him and threatened his life again, he was permitted to verbally repeat those defensive words to save himself.

Question 76:

Under what circumstances is migrating (Hijrah) considered a religious obligation, and when is moving to a non-Muslim country forbidden (haram)?

Answer: Migration is a virtue and obligation if a person cannot freely practice their religion or protect their family's values in their current homeland. However, moving from an Islamic land to a non-Muslim country where one is unable to practice their religion, resulting in the loss of family values and faith, is considered a forbidden act known as Taa'rrub ba'd al-Hijrah.

Question 77:

What did Ja'far ibn Abi Talib recite to King Najashi of Abyssinia that brought the Christian king and priests to tears and secured asylum for the Muslims?

Answer: He recited the opening verses of Surah Maryam, specifically describing the miraculous birth and story of Prophet Jesus, which deeply moved the King and his priests, leading them to refuse to hand the Muslim refugees back to the Quraysh.

Question 78:

What is the literal meaning of the Arabic word "istiqamah", and how is it defined conceptually?

Answer: "Istiqamah" literally means to stand firm and steadfast on the right path. Conceptually, it represents standing firm on one's feet and refusing to deviate to the right or left, regardless of the hardships or difficulties faced.

Question 79:

Why does every individual face a completely different set of trials and difficulties in life?

Answer: This life is an examination where every person is given a unique question sheet. God knows exactly what type of question and scenario is suitable for each specific student in the school of religion.

Question 80:

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Preparation

What physical metaphor explains the relationship between patience (sabr) and faith (iman)?

Answer: Patience is compared to the head of a physical body. Just as a body cannot survive if its head is removed, faith cannot exist or survive without patience.

Question 81:

What terrifying sight stopped Abu Jahl from dropping a rock on the Prophet's head?

Answer: As he approached, Abu Jahl became petrified and retreated because he saw a scary ghost that he had never seen before in his life.

Question 82:

What did the companion who courageously volunteered to openly recite Surah al-Rahman in Masjid al-Haram say after being beaten by the polytheists until he fainted?

Answer: Upon waking, he told his friends: "By Allah, the enemies of Allah have never been so little in my eyes as of today. If you wish, I can repeat this again tomorrow".

Question 83:

What is "Taa'rrub ba'd al-Hijrah", and why is it considered a mortal sin?

Answer: It is the act of traveling from an Islamic land to a non-Islamic country where a person is unable to freely practice their religion, resulting in the loss of Islamic values and faith for themselves and their children.

Question 84:

What is the literal translation of the Arabic word for miracle, "mu'jizah", and what does this concept convey?

Answer: The word "mu'jizah" literally means something that makes people unable, or disables them from presenting what is being done. This conveys that a true miracle is an act that ordinary human beings are completely incapable of reproducing.

Question 85:

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Preparation

Why is the translation of the Arabic word "ayah" as "verse" considered inaccurate, and what is its true spiritual meaning?

Answer: The term "verse" is traditionally used for poetry or standard sentences in biblical texts, which does not capture the true meaning of the word. "Ayah" literally translates to "divine sign". It signifies that every single sentence of the Quran is a physical miracle in and of itself.

Question 86:

What is the difference between something being "scientifically impossible" versus "logically impossible"?

Answer: A scientific impossibility is a phenomenon that goes against the established physical and natural laws that humans understand, such as bringing a deceased person back to life. A logical impossibility is something that violates the absolute law of contradiction. Miracles are scientifically impossible because they go out of the ordinary physical laws of nature, but they are logically possible because they do not violate any laws of contradiction.

Question 87:

What is the philosophical analogy of the "kingdom of plants" used by Aristotle to explain how miracles operate?

Answer: If plants could communicate, they would deny that a plant could travel from one city to another city as an absolute physical impossibility. However, a human being—a higher species with greater capabilities—can easily uproot a plant and fly it across continents in a few hours. Similarly, a miracle is simply the creator of nature, God, interfering in the natural physical laws from a higher level of reality.

Question 88:

How are the miracles of the Prophet categorized based on their expression, and how does this compare to previous prophets?

Answer: The miracles are divided into verbal miracles (words uttered, like the Quran) and action miracles (demonstrations of physical feats similar to those performed by previous prophets). While previous prophets were only given physical miracles of action, the Prophet was uniquely given both verbal and physical miracles.

Question 89:

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Preparation

How did the Prophet establish the reality of the splitting of the moon to polytheists who claimed it was just magic played on their eyes?

Answer: When the polytheists claimed that the splitting of the moon was merely an optical illusion or magic played on their vision, they decided to wait for caravans traveling back from Yemen and Syria. When the travelers returned days later, they confirmed that they had also witnessed the moon split into two halves on that exact night, leaving the skeptics unable to deny the physical event.

Question 90:

What is the historical account of the miracle of "Radd al-Shams" (returning of the sun) involving Imam Ali?

Answer: Imam Ali did not move to pray his Asr prayer because the Prophet was resting or asleep with his head on Ali's lap. By the time the Prophet woke up, the sun had already set. The Prophet prayed to God to return the sun so Ali could pray, and the sun rose back up in the sky to allow him to offer his prayer.

Question 91:

What was the nature of the Miraculous Ascension (Mi'raj), and how many times did it occur?

Answer: The ascension was both a physical and spiritual journey where the Prophet transcended the physical universe to witness the realities of heaven and hell. According to narrations from Imam al-Sadiq, the Prophet underwent this heavenly ascension 120 times.

Question 92:

How did the Prophet miraculously control the storm clouds in Medina during a severe drought?

Answer: After a severe drought, the Prophet prayed for rain, causing an immediate, heavy downpour. When the people feared a destructive flood, he prayed for the rain to fall on the outskirts of the city. The clouds immediately dispersed into a perfect circle or ring around Medina, raining only in the surrounding valleys and mountains while leaving the city dry and safe.

Question 93:

What is the story of the two trees that united in the barren desert, and what was the purpose of this miracle?

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Answer: He commanded his companion to tell two separate, distant trees to unite. Upon receiving the command, the trees uprooted themselves, moved together, and joined so tightly that they formed a single thick trunk.

Question 94:

Why did the dry date palm trunk, "Hannanah", cry in the Prophet's mosque, and how was it pacified?

Answer: The Prophet used to lean on this trunk while delivering weekly sermons. When a wooden pulpit (minbar) was built and he walked past the trunk to use the new pulpit, the trunk began to weep and mourn loudly like a baby camel missing its mother. It only stopped when the Prophet descended from his pulpit and wrapped his arms around the wood to hug it.

Question 95:

What miraculous event occurred regarding the meat presented to the Prophet by a Jewish woman after the Battle of Khaybar?

Answer: A Jewish woman presented a piece of cooked lamb as a gift to test if he was a true prophet. As the food was served, the meat itself spoke to the Prophet, warning him that it was poisoned, allowing him and his companions to refrain from eating it.

Question 96:

What was the miraculous event involving the revival of two boys in Medina?

Answer: An Ansari couple's older son accidentally killed his younger brother while mimicking their father slaughtering a goat, and then fell from a window and died. The mother hid the bodies out of respect for the Prophet, who was their dinner guest. Warned by Gabriel, the Prophet insisted on seeing the boys, prayed over them, and both boys instantly sat up and returned to life as if waking from sleep.

Question 97:

How has modern science validated the alignment of the Mihrab (prayer niche) in the Prophet's Mosque in Medina?

Answer: The Prophet established the direction of the Qiblah for his mosque in Medina without using any geographical, compass, or astronomical tools. Modern astronomers have calculated the alignment and found that his placement of the Mihrab points mathematically and precisely toward the Kaaba.

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Question 98:

According to Islamic theology, from what point in their lives are prophets and Imams considered divinely protected from committing sins or making errors?

Answer: They are divinely protected from birth to death in all matters of their lives.

Question 99:

What are the two main categories of verses in the Quran as defined in Surah Ali 'Imran (Chapter 3, Verse 7), and how do they relate to each other?

Answer: The two categories are:

1. Muhkam (established verses): Verses with clear, established meanings that form the basis or foundation of the book.
2. Mutashabih (ambiguous verses): Verses whose meanings are not immediately clear due to the limitations of human language. To understand the ambiguous verses, they must be referred back to and interpreted in light of the established verses.

Question 100:

Approximately how many verses out of the more than 6,000 verses in the Quran are considered ambiguous by experts?

- Answer: Experts estimate that up to a maximum of 200 verses are ambiguous.

Question 101:

In the event of "Abasa wa Tawalla" (عَبَسَ وَتَوَلَّى) (He frowned and turned away) described in Surah Abasa, who do narrations from the Ahl al-Bayt identify as the person who actually frowned at the blind man?

Answer: They identify the person as a wealthy man from the clan of Bani Umayyah who was sitting with the Prophet and pulled his clothes away in disgust when the poor, blind Muslim sat next to him.

Question 102:

What is the distinction between the "Greater Jihad" (Jihad al-Akbar)?

Answer: The Greater Jihad is the internal, lifetime struggle against self-egoism and desires to combat the unseen enemy within.

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